Signals of Life Demand some Death



autofictional novel

in vignettes

start reading ->

Gorm Braarvig
gorm@aigap.no



https://aigap.no/mlist

Zero Sum

"Riding my motorcycle from Kiel to Alicante
averaging 170 km/h,
I could have been arrested all over Europe", I said.
The lawyer I had just met over a Whisky chuckled.
"No, you should be dead"

Maybe so, but I feel nothing anyway, except shame
towards my loved ones. Perhaps through Music,
I can experience the loss of sanity as sound,
time standing still, breakdown and realization.

Death makes room

Zero-Summary

Nothing Compares 2 U, Sinéad O'Connor

https://aigap.no/mncty



Does new life demand that something old dies to make space? Are resources and therefore opportunities limited?

Zero-Summary is about resource allocation without the ability to create resources from nothing; you must choose between keeping old things alive and creating something new. There isn't room to do both at once.

A result measure of innovation that few understand is how much you manage to stop doing to make room for something new. Some call the effect of having too much "legacy cost", and the system is often referred to as "the Zero-Sum Game". An alternative to the model is to assume that you can create value through progress and not just distribute value based on yesterday's premises. Positive-sum games are described in a later chapter. For this death also entails that the zero-sum model must die, but it must be felt first.

Innovation gives progress; I don't think we call it innovation if it doesn't entail a new perceived improvement. For some, it's enough that the experience is new for innovation to have occurred. For me, it has been true, as with artificial intelligence being perceived as innovative after 50 years, when the world was ready to use the ideas, but not before. Therefore, I write about perceived improvement, because the real improvement can only be experienced indirectly. I know my own subjective truths and choose with integrity to speak about them instead.

Starting with some true stories from my life, unbalanced and occasionally objectively imprecise. Raw, fragmented, provocatively desperate.

If I, for example, say "the motorcycle helmet cracked, not like in the movies, but in a senseless crash that once again embedded itself as lasting physical fear in my body," it might be that the episode was more dramatic for those who saw me go down. Or less.

My feeling is nonetheless true and neither underreported nor dramatized. Whether people have believed they witnessed a fatal accident, or a triviality, is their story. For me, it can be omitted or inflated. If the reader is provoked, it gives room for interpretation.

The old is no more

Ohne Dich, Rammstein

https://aigap.no/mod



The sound of glass plate shattering into a thousand pieces is the sound you hear when a motorcycle helmet is destroyed on the ground. If you're wearing the helmet.

The world I knew had gone to hell. I remember the moment I realized it, just before I went into a coma. The world didn't go to hell in an instant, but the realization came like a bang I've only experienced when I smash a motorcycle helmet headfirst into the asphalt. I remember three of the four times I've smashed my helmet, all have left lasting mark on me. I don't know why realization that world is not the same could hit harder than life-threatening accidents, but it did.

“Ohne Dich” - An hour into a conversation with “J", a far too young, and for her own happiness, brilliant, Ukrainian

romantic interest, we shared musical favorites. My chosen song, a song by Rammstein, is about the loss of a mother. For me, the song is not only about the loss of my own mother, but is also an emotional anchor for many things that are forever lost. Without you, I cannot exist in the same way.

The young woman I spoke to daily lived in a borrowed holiday cabin in Bordeaux, where she also cared for her mother. The apartments the family owned in Kiev no longer had any full windows, they had all been shattered as a result of the city being bombed. The bright girl needed full windows around her in her international middle management job.

"Und die Vögel singen nicht mehr". When I first met her I found out she was smarter than me. A bottomless woman who noticed that I registered that she was a multidimensional being. Not oversensitive like Scandinavian gifted ladies, although they too are doomed to a life of more ability than happiness. This woman from war-torn Ukraine was also doomed to a life of cruelty baptized by evil and pain. The underlying nerdy vulnerability is the same in all those women who received books as reward when they were good girls, but those gifted from war and misery lose life's illusions in bottomless pain. The bird sings no more.

"Mit dir bin ich auch allein". There was nothing I could say that changed the fact that the ground beneath her feet was gone. Her home, her mother's and sister's home, and the remains of a gifted family who came from Tsjornobyl were destroyed. I haven't dug into all the hidden stories that must lie there, but they could probably fill a bookshelf full of books. I kept it a secret from J that, driven by anger, I was determined to travel and take up arms in Ukraine, even as a 20 years too old ex Recon soldier, I saw the Russians as the aggressors of all of Europe at that time. But there was something else that almost killed me. J and I enjoyed each other's attention, but were already alone in shared moments.

"Mit dir stehen die Sekunden". After inviting J to ride my motorcycle when she stopped by Oslo on a work trip, I found out I could do better. After intuitively sensing the fear she was trying to hide, I gave her another break from life. Attention and a conversation with a man who enjoyed her company with bubbles and mussels to the sea breeze under the sun. The second hand stopped with her.

“Doch der Abend wirft ein Tuch aufs Land”. Afterwards we went to the place for bubbles, attention and more break from the hard life. When she stretched her body and the time really came to kiss her, I laughed in a way that could only be understood as offensive. Self-destruction took over from

passion and just an hour later I kissed her goodbye on the forehead like a sibling. The adventure was over and the night on dark roads awaited. The evening cloth over the world had already been thrown.

In a normal world, I would have married such a woman, but my world was already on fire.

"Ohne dich zähl ich die Stunden". I gave up on the world. It was the COVID epidemic when I started regularly life-threatening driving at night with a heavy motorcycle. Mostly with alcohol in my blood. After I was acting as co-judge in a pedophile case, the pain inside me became so intense that normal fear and pain thresholds disappeared. The beauty of the night, survival of mortal danger, the brutality and the encounter with the wild animals of the night drowned out the reasonable horror. In no way did I want to exterminate myself, on the other hand I appreciated life more for each surprising survival. The house keys were lost on a beach in the south, I didn't want to go home, I didn't know that the countdown in hours had begun.

"Mit dir steh'n die Sekunden". In moments of mortal danger, when seconds stand still, one can be alone, but not lonely. The fourth time I smashed a helmet on the asphalt, I felt neither pain nor noise. At first I was hyperfocused on

how to stop, because I was skidding at a sufficiently high speed, head first into the roadway. After stopping I called my daughters and their mother to tell them I had flipped my bike. Finally, I took a break while a veterinarian saved my life. She used her blouse to slow the bleeding enough for the ambulance to get me to the emergency room in time. I know this because she got the money back for her blouse on my insurance. Consciousness disappeared; with you, seconds stand still.

But I have skipped some stories.



MC to the Mediterranean and a flame

Wanted *Dead or Alive, Bon Jovi*

https://aigap.no/mwdoa



Heavy motorcycle. It's December 2022 and bike season is over. Whether it was safe to ride or not, was judged based on whether forecast had shown sub-zero temperatures during the night; now it wasn't safe anymore. If you ride on ice with a heavy motorcycle, the front wheel slips and you immediately hit the ground with no chance to influence it. That's how I destroyed my first Ducati and my first helmet.

I found a map of Europe and looked at where I could stay from December to March where it was above freezing; Italy was high on the list.

"It's all the same, only the names will change". I looked at the map; the Mediterranean looked good, Italy, Spain, maybe Morocco or Turkey. The country was unimportant; what mattered was the escape

from a Norway of isolation, freezing temperatures, and stagnation. The drive was unshakable. Everything is the same: cities, people, and values. There are many different names for the freedom I sought.

Suddenly I remembered my former girlfriend and cohabitant from the first half of my twenties, "C", who had moved to Alicante to write a book about Francisco Franco. C is a delightfully over-gifted creature from the West End of Oslo who has been a good friend since I met her, and we have maintained a friendship after we broke up. C is fun.

"Every day it seems we're wastin' away". After a week of winter storage, my patience was gone; the feeling of wasting valuable time drove me to act. Being stuck in Oslo while life and the world burned with COVID fear and depression was more harmful than physical danger, people's opinions of me, career, or money. Every day in winter-Oslo was a day wasted.

I called C and asked if I could have a base with her in Spain while I rode the MC along the Mediterranean this winter? She answered affirmatively and welcomed me; lodging was sorted.

Once again, I would experience the personality between C and myself. In many people's opinion, personality doesn't exist in individuals

as important as between people. C and I are compatible and could easily have been married for life. Some relationships are built on lies or unrealistic hopes, but the connection between us was good and real, far too good to last in a zero-sum world.

"I'd drive all night just to get back home". I have denied my home; my new home was being on the road, first symbolized by the Mediterranean with Alicante, visiting warm C and a new start. Sleep and security were not part of my new home; they were illusions anyway. I was used to driving all night, and the road was already my new home.

Then the practicalities had to be solved; the snow had come, and transport through winter Europe on an MC is neither uncomplicated nor cheap. I decided to take the Kiel ferry as soon as possible and drive through the continent while there was a pocket of above-freezing temperatures.

Due to COVID, everyone in the directorate I received a salary from was required to work from home, and I saw no need to flaunt the truth—the truth that my cabin office was going to be "along the Mediterranean" for a period; it was no one else's business. The work on national investigations had transparency and archival obligations and no security reason for me to have to stay in Norway. Developing future shared solutions for the benefit of citizens had no real use in me sitting at

Norwegian soil. Here I defied bureaucracy and the clammy hands of trade unions; it would turn out not to pay off, but that's another matter.

I planned three routes through Europe: the optimistic, the beautiful, and the realistic.

The optimistic route involved high speed over a long time; the beautiful route maximized experiences and riding pleasure, while the realistic route accounted for weather changes and exhaustion. All three routes were "projected" with calendar entries, map references, and links to weather forecasts between Kiel and Alicante. Then it was just a matter of waiting for the first ferry after lockdown; it would take weeks, but on January 3rd, I was on my way! The MC was moved to Oslo quay by a crane truck, the first of three crane truck trips for the adventure.

"I'm a cowboy. On a steel horse I ride". On the road I was not a father, not a colleague, but an old-fashioned archetype of a man, a lone rider on a minimalist, dangerous motorcycle without wind protection. The feeling of being an outlaw, with the steel horse as my tool, let me numb pain, classical reason, and fear in an inferno of wind noise. An outlaw old-fashioned man on a steel horse.

The 3400 kilometers from Kiel to Alicante were completed at full throttle, and even though I had a very reliable bike, it broke down the first time already before I reached Hamburg.

"I'm wanted dead or alive". With an average speed of 170 km/h, I lived in a constant borderland between prison, madness, or my own fatal accident. I am still ashamed of it because of my children, but adrenaline and endorphins boiled: willing to pay the highest price for my new freedom, I had fled a slow, silent, greyish death in a bureaucracy overcrowded with case officers at a strategic level. It was like I learned in the military's reconnaissance service: my duty as a prisoner was to escape. I felt wanted, dead or alive.

After a period at top speed, 220 km/h, the motorcycle broke down, and I was forced to take a 24-hour break while it was repaired. A two-day stop in Hamburg during COVID was not my favorite, but in return, a lot of work was done from the hotel on "Digital assistant for Norway, organizational perspective". A socially beneficial task that is more boring than it sounds.

"Another place where the faces are so cold". Hamburg during the COVID lockdown was a pause from the speed, but a reminder of the world's coldness where everyone goes to work in a machine where they

fighting over limited resources. A useful, relevant framework for working on national solutions for Norwegian citizens. I repaired the clutch and worked, surrounded by a city that was as lifeless as my own inner state before I left. Hamburg already stood for me as morally decayed, but now I experienced it even more unfiltered. Another place where the faces are blank and cold, just as much as back home in Norway, only more honest and shamelessly lost to illusions.

I found a bench outside the workshop where I could sit and work; then I could get on the bike the moment it was ready. I paid, fastened the bag over the seat, and continued with renewed courage southward at top speed. The roads had to go further west now, as the night frost made it unrealistic to ride at full throttle and arrive alive further inland. The frost-free time window had almost closed.

"Sometimes I sleep, sometimes it's not for days". The trip lasted only twenty hours of constant full throttle. Stops for refueling, border crossings, and tolls added perhaps four more hours, so the total riding time was only about a day. The time pockets in which I could ride the bike without danger of ice on the road were the real limitation.

"I play for keeps 'cause I might not make it back". My self-destructive assessment of risk was confirmed by the speed and

what was to come. Every kilometer was an acknowledgment that I might not come back alive; a deadly game to numb the pain inside me was playing at high volume. It wasn't the first time I rode harder than my brain was really capable of; it can be done with any combination of little sleep, night riding, alcohol, or excessive speed. This time too, sleep was not for well-being, joy, or luxury, only a means to warm a shivering body that couldn't handle more adrenaline mixed with cold; the soul wanted to continue, driven by raw will and a mental state of exception in search of mortal danger. I was playing for real, because I might not come back.

Sometimes I sleep, sometimes I don't for days. On previous trips, I slept much less; when I got cold enough, only a few hours of sleep could enable me to continue without shivering, visual disturbances, and other psychological signs of exhaustion making a sleep break time-saving. This time I was limited by sub-zero temperatures, but I made up for it by constantly giving full throttle.

The next noteworthy experience was only two to three hours away; the Afsluitdijk road lies in the middle of the sea with no land in sight on either side. I thought about how nice this trip could have been if I were riding a Cruiser-MC you see in movies or TV series, a "pimpmobile" as I called it, slowly chugging along

while I enjoyed riding in the middle of the sea on my way to the desert where Westerns are filmed in Spain. After allowing myself a slow half-hour worthy of a fifty-year-old man, I returned to top speed and adrenaline in a world of wind noise and mortal danger in foreign lands.

After about 900 km, I found Boulogne-sur-Mer in France; it was starting to get dangerously close to freezing, and with about 2000 km left, it was a good time to find a place to stop and enjoy red wine along the French coast.

Ideally, it was only a hard day's ride to San Sebastian, inside the Spanish border, but because it was winter, I had to ride far west to avoid the life-threatening freezing temperatures; as far as I can remember, it took an extra day. During this period, I was a bit dazed by the adrenaline raging through my body. I was on the edge of what my body and brain could handle. Life was beautiful, cold, and dangerous. I was in a natural high of euphoric joy from constantly surviving mortal danger in a body pushed to its absolute limits regarding cold, wind noise, and stress.

The luxury of healing the extreme exhaustion of body and nervous system came later, on a beach by the Mediterranean.

"The people I meet always go their separate ways". The motorcycle secured micro-relationships, temporary ones; I was committed to the road, the danger, and the speed. The experience of France got worse and worse the closer I got to Spain, which provided a stark contrast to the holiday paradise of San Sebastian, an oasis just inside the Spanish border. I had passed J, my Ukrainian love interest in Southern France, without easing off the throttle; the adrenaline was all-consuming and I was on my way to C. Had I known I was only a few hours of wild riding from Alicante, I would have continued, but because I assumed the roads were as dangerous in Spain as in Norway, I stopped and enjoyed paradise for a few hours. In the fashionable area around the beach in San Sebastian, I had a meal with two upper-class women of color I met in line. The food featured extraordinary ingredients, but the conversation was only about shopping and clothes. I was already looking forward to the open road and went to the hotel to talk to J. The people I meet always go their separate ways.

"I still drive, dead or alive". On the roads in Germany, France, and Spain, you could mostly ride at top speed. Lockdown due to COVID, little traffic, and little visible police set the framework for riding that would otherwise have been stopped. Through other countries, it went a bit slower, so it wasn't top speed the whole way. The average speed, according to the map application, was therefore 170 km/h for the entire stretch from Kiel to Alicante, including detours: 3400 km.

completed with 20 hours of active riding and 15-20 stops for fuel. The relatively high speed still sometimes makes me cry with shame, as I have children who deserve me to at least stay alive. Before the realization of the danger, and long before the shame, I continued. The only truth was the movement. Regardless of outcome, survival or death, I was driven to continue the journey. I still ride, but finally more alive than dead.

"Oh, and I ride". The next morning after breakfast, the bike cut through the Pyrenees mountain range. The experience was better than I could have imagined; the best of Spain, France, and Norway combined into one integrated experience. The Spanish facilitation for high speed, French style, and a natural landscape close to what I was used to from Norway's fantastic fjords. The roads were banked in a way that gave confidence that it was safe to hold full throttle through the curves. In a stolen moment, my thoughts went to the consequence of dying. A mistake in a curve or a little oil spill was more than enough for an accident at 200 km/h, and the result is that rider and vehicle become an integrated part of the terrain. Accidents over 100 km/h are fatal, and double the speed has four times the force, so death is more or less guaranteed if you fail.

The thought of risk soon let go; I was numb and distracted. My nervous system, pummeled by endorphins and

adrenaline, was only capable of experiencing the state that lies between life and death. It may also be that the addictive speed had settled in my body. The motorcycle was an effective tool for a speed high. I was driven by a nameless force, an unconscious motor that kept me moving south. I didn't ride to think, but to feel; I could feel that I was alive, without letting thoughts in. Oh, and I ride.

"I got the night on my side". The numb joy of surviving, and the instinct that ignored danger, had taken a deeper hold on me than on other trips; this time not at night, but in time windows without frost. I have the night on my side. I gave in to my dark forces, which at a later time would annihilate me.

Spain proved to have the best and most fun roads I got to enjoy. They are built for constant top speed; the warmth of the Mediterranean hit me before I was really finished enjoying the roads. But at 1000 meters above sea level, I understood the value of the Mediterranean; the warmth and humidity told me I was closer to the cradle of humanity. Finally about to come home to die, although fate made me return to Oslo before I could ride myself to death along the Mediterranean.

Suddenly I was at C's; it would be a new chapter.

for her and a note in the margin for myself; everyone around me had become spectators to my death ritual on the road. The time without top speed grew shorter for each day. I was alive, and was going to be happy by the Mediterranean for weeks.

But my sanity had let go.



Abuse and wounds
Knockin' on Heaven's Door, Dylan
https://aigap.no/mkohd



Evening. I drove with the devil at my heels. Didn't reflect on the dust on the road to Oslo municipality. Just before I spun out of control and flew over the handlebars, I reflected on the day.

The morning had started right here, full throttle out of Oslo and south. Then the phone rang.

I stopped and drove up onto the pavement at Sørenga. Called back immediately. "I don't want to go alone", she said. "My girlfriend isn't answering". I didn't need to think it over. "When do you need me?"

M is a sister from another family that isn't a family. Everything I would do for a biological sister, I would do for M. "When?" She paused and then spoke quickly. "Now. I have to appear in

the court in ten minutes". I hung up, turned around, and gave full throttle.

The Court of Appeal smelled of the coffee that makes your stomach feel hollow. M sat on a chair ready to go in. Warm hug, then everyday phrases. The accused, M's cousin, passed by without a word. Looked like he was on his way to a routine day at work.

Silence.

"What's the case about?" I wondered, a little curious but unshakably supportive of M regardless. "My cousin has raped his girlfriend", she said. "I reported it". "What did the police say?" "That it depends on the evidence". She laughed, briefly. "As if sleep rape is easy to prove". She knew, when she reported her own cousin, that the family was lost after this, but enough is enough. Strong and weak.

I didn't follow the proceedings; I heard the judge say "the burden of proof" in a subordinate clause. M sat still. The worst that could happen. The victim was not believed; M had betrayed her own family without visible result. Unforgivable and unavoidable. Brave sister. The worst that could happen. What happens to those who speak up.

There is no consequence to leaning too far out. Until you fall.

The accused smiled confidently. Routine. "Love is love".

I have seen it before. As a lay judge. A Norwegian man, fifty, Filipino children. "Play with the sixteen-year-old". The pedophiles add ten years when they talk about age. Twelve years in prison. "Legal practice". "Sentencing". A professional judge nods. "The Supreme Court agrees". Twelve years and two million for twelve lives; the system works exceptionally.

I asked M, "will your cousin do it again?" She nodded in confirmation. "Against others, his son or grandson too". Here the system would not work. "The burden of proof", says the judge; we had all foreseen it. "Not beyond a reasonable doubt", the defense lawyer had said; he got it and was right. Legal protection for Norwegian girls is weak.

I think of the window I am falling out of.

Whisky under the plastic palms. M talks with her girlfriend about renovations. Acceptance that the world is broken; I think of those who will abuse tomorrow.

Accelerating into the night.

I fly over the bike and am heading into the darkness. Consciousness and sense return after a few weeks. Second floor at

Rikshospitalet. I see M through a veil of morphine. "Now you are prepared", she says.

Only later do I understand what she means. The fall was the beginning. Not the end.

Free fall, but I got back up.



200 km/h, and beyond
Battle Without Honor or Humanity

https://aigap.no/mbwhoh



When riding motorcycle at top speed through night, you are visible and audible. It is a secret that the rider has a state of absolute, liberating silence.

Your body enters a state of hyperfocus driven by fear of annihilation. Senses dull, impressions leave after minutes of madness.

Deafening, monotonous roar of wind against your helmet fades first. Next, any conscious reflection on movements, curves, scenery, wildlife, traffic, and lights disappears. Your existence dissolves into routine motions and actions, patterns and vibrations. Details slip away from every sense.

Finally bodily pain and tension vanish. There is no room for strain. Energy is conserved, and breathing shifts downward towards calm, deep rhythm from the belly. Shoulders drop, pain and your brains exhaustion gets filtered out. You enter a hypnotic state that surpasse sitting in lotus position or using drugs.

All psychological troubles become irrelevant, pain too. Ultimate silence lies at heart of a deafening roar, sound audible from afar, unheard when you are sitting where the noise originates. You do not need Freud nor Jung; you are healed. Or die.

Zero-sum life dies; creation without destruction becomes possible. Death makes way for new life.



The Accident
Time to die, The Stranglers
https://aigap.no/mttd



I had a Brown Tequila with M and her girlfriend.

Brown Tequila in the morning and a life-threatening accident in the evening. It gave experiences that can never be unlearned.

The part of me that died from the life-saving treatment in the ER *gave the opportunity for the end of a life, an identity, a self. How much I would keep of what I had been, I could choose myself. The advantage of coma and delirium is that so little remains of who you were that you can rewrite yourself.*

Physically, the life I knew was over. A month in the ER *and months of morphine changed everything. The acceptance that the life I had before was gone was easy; an unclear period had received a definitive end, and the body was healed.*

Life-saving treatment for polytrauma is given with a small or large team; a small one was enough for me. The injuries included fractures in some of the upper vertebrae, lung bleeding, eleven broken ribs, high-energy fractures, and a broken little finger. No one bothered with the little finger, so it still looks a bit strange. Some things are extreme enough that they must be experienced to be understood.

It wasn't the injuries that made me lose my mind. Pulmonary emphysema, a bleeding following the surgeries or the accident, had reached the lungs. Too little oxygen to the brain. I experienced it as delusions and physical anxiety. What distinguishes physical anxiety from intellectual is that it is useful to rationalize with someone who has the intellectual type.

I flew over the handlebars of the motorcycle at speed, slow enough for survival, fast enough for major injuries. The first thing to hit the ground breaks; for me, it was the right leg.

Injuries

The fracture was category type 3b. Fractures are divided into levels one, two, and three. Level three is again divided into a, b, and c. Statistically, 3a, b, and c result in amputation in 5, 25, and 50 percent of cases, respectively. My fracture carried a 25% chance of amputation, multi-trauma, and serious injuries around the body. Probability of cognitive reduction. Various

types of permanent sequelae, both physical and psychological.

"Like shifting sands in an ocean's bed". Blood pooling in the lungs limited oxygen supply to the brain enough that, according to medical records, I had uncontrolled tremors and anxiety, so I went into the psychotic state of delirium. Nothing was stable anymore; identity, body, and reality were in motion.

The spine had compression fractures in the 2nd, 3rd, and 6th vertebrae from the top, but I was not paralyzed.

Although half the ribs were broken, they had stayed in place, and those that were displaced did not puncture vital organs. I woke up with plastic along one whole side of my chest, but I don't know if it was because they were picking gravel out of me or had adjusted puncturing ribs; it's not important.

Minor injuries, like a fractured shoulder blade and a broken little finger, were ignored the first week while the many life-saving operations were performed and the leg was saved. Hence, I'm left with minor permanent issues like a crooked little finger and a nervous system that doesn't feel enough pain when it really should.

Treatment

Magic Arrow, Timber Timbre

https://aigap.no/mma



Treatments included countless surgeries, skin grafts, being placed in a coma, and treatment for delirium. Delirium is a psychotic state many enter when medication use, surgeries, lack of oxygen to the brain, and other injuries cross the limit of what a human can handle. You don't know how much it takes before you lose your mind, until it happens.

Morphine of all types was implanted in the body, placed in the back, given intravenously, and served in pill form. Fast-acting and long-acting.

After the worst was over physically, psychiatric medication for two days, and the delirium disappeared. An unexpected glimmer of hope, a small spark, was enough to come back from the abyss. I undeservedly returned completely without either tranquilizers or sleeping pills.

Experience

During the delirium, I was convinced the surgeries were financed by naked TV, and that drones were attacking the hospital to kill me. I had what I would call physical anxiety, something fundamentally different from intellectual anxiety. Convinced that my daughter had a face tattoo and that my Ukrainian friend should take care of planning my treatment, I was surely an irritating patient. Intense disorientation must be experienced to be understood; delirium, chaos, and halluci- nations are no more understandable than quantum physics. After the episode, I have never again asked anyone to pull themselves together if they are scared; I am now aware that it is not a given that it is possible. The period of delirium appears as real, fully formed memories, where I had a different understanding of reality; it is a past I accept. Knowledge, hope, and self-perception slip away, like memories that don't hold; the loss of control is lasting; I thank every day that I am free of anxiety and paranoia.

Siblings

S once saw a short film of me from before the accident, and I didn't understand why she cried. People around me probably have a deeper insight into how much the accident has changed me than it is possible for me to have myself. I know that the blood clot that moved around in my body is one of the things that could have killed me and may have given me permanent damage. The body went into uncontrollable tremors I don't remember, and

despite being strong and clear through injuries, surgeries, and medication, I went into delirium as my body fought for life. Oxygen deprivation to the brain changed everything.

My youngest sister never thought I would be the same again. While the doctors fought for my life, she saw three possible outcomes. Big brother would die, or become an invalid, and the freedom he had finally gotten with the MC life was over. The chance that everything would be as before was minimal to her. I will never know if I became as before; only she knows.

The advantage of going crazy is, as is also said about death and stupidity, that it is not your own problem, only a problem for those closest to you. The disadvantage of going crazy is that it is a problem for those around you. It is not important for me to know if I have ended up with a permanent personality change or lower cognitive abilities; it lies beyond the horizon and gives no joy to know. Not possible for me to see or measure, and if I ask those closest to me, they may be too shaped by their own traumas, by believing they would lose me, to be able to answer.

I am stuck in the collapsed version of myself; I cannot allow myself to float back to a dangerous life without harming those I love. Assessments of one's own and others' potential quickly become limited by how one observes, just as quantum physics is inaccessible to our brains. Superpositions in the quantum world are limited down to following the need of the observer. Will assessments of me be in the context of my relationship to the observer, our intuitive understanding of both

dimensionality and probability is shaped by our ability to observe, both emotionally and abstractly.

"Love me for who I am, not my potential", I have said to loves, but never to a sister or daughter.

My relationships with my sisters and daughters have become worse.

The life as it was is no more. But it doesn't have to be worse; now there is room to build something new.

Delusions

Not all delusions can I write about. Some are still too painful to talk about for those I care about. Tears fall just thinking about it. Other delusions are just funny memories.

The department at Ullevål hospital where they conduct acute life-saving efforts, the trauma center, the ER, has a helipad where helicopters constantly land. Every time a helicopter landed, a drone attack where I was to be killed unfolded in my brain. It started when my head got too little oxygen. The records reveal that my extremities, arms and legs, began to shake uncontrollably. I was going to die. The brain got too little oxygen, and delusions were next. First, an innocent drone flew around the artificial nutrition I was receiving; the drone took pictures.

I complained about the imaginary drone and remember the nurses nodding understandingly but not solving the problem. Because my stepdaughter's husband at the time flew drones for the police, I interpreted it as the family being there and watching.

Then came veterans from the military after me. First, an MC club from Trøndelag; they were after me because I left the military too early. Didn't take foreign service. A woman from the MC club walked in and out and was going to coordinate how they would take me out of play.

As time went on, the stories grew together, and everyone from the military national shooting competition, which had been held somewhere I had recently visited, was going to kill me with drones from a distance. I knew death was imminent and was constantly given new times when I would be shot.

It was completely out of the question for my family to visit. They had to survive.



Blank pages
Little Wing, Jimi Hendrix
https://aigap.no/mlw



When I woke up, I had room. Room to breathe, room to see. The coma had cleared away part of the old life, the heavy, self-destructive past, and made room for a completely new life with completely new possibilities. Sanity died; I had, in a way, annihilated myself, but a void was created to build a completely new life.

I was her first patient at the elitist Rikshospitalet, and she told me about the trips she wanted to take in the mountains. I told her about mine I had planned in the Pyrenees with J. I convinced her to go to a Rammstein concert. She remembered me and our relationship well two years later when I came for a check-up; we had shared many conversations while I was in Delirium and using morphine.

Three years after discharge, I tracked her down and sent a message. The adventure was no longer her reality. That's okay.

Strength from neglect
The Logical Song, Supertramp
https://aigap.no/mtls



Three years after the accident, I sit in a student café. My attention goes to a young couple sitting diagonally across from me. They are probably in their late twenties, apparently successful, fit, and well-groomed; they probably both do yoga. I tell myself they have never in their lives had an unpaid bill, been in a fight, or failed an exam. There is a sexless baby on the mother's lap; the father sits knitting; maybe he is a practicing feminist.

The couple makes me reflect on my own parents' carefree 70s idyll as rich kids; their frivolity infected me. When I was young, life was wonderful.

Once I had entered the café, I saw a woman occupying the four best seats. When asked if one was free,

she shook her head. The smell of genderless nihilism from people who have never experienced real resistance or an unpaid bill, the Norwegian coldness. Clinical, intellectual, and cynical.

The woman who wouldn't share space spots the poodle I have with me and looks like she wants contact. I wrinkle my nose; in that I have something she wants, contact with a small dog, I welcome the young woman; she is a kind of symbol of a secure, house-savings generation who will get paid by a public bureaucracy funded by oil money. But never create anything new for others. Logical, responsible, and practical.

I don't know where the contempt comes from; I have always promised myself I would never become a grumpy old man, but maybe it's inevitable. The man who has been sitting knitting toys and playing with the baby, maybe everything is as it should be; how bad can it be that a man has become a woman? Another young mother has joined the couple's conversation, a quick and engaged conversation in a brash Bergen dialect. Maybe there is nothing wrong after all; maybe the world has always been like this, and I'm just hypersensitive to the changes I myself am going through. The distance I want from the zero-sum game they are all playing. The knitting man puts on a lady's coat and walks after the women without helping.

Maybe the couple was a bit like my own parents in the 70s.

While the 68ers were liberated from work, colored by women's liberation, today's youth are colored by resistance to offense. Neither the generation before me nor the one after have been hardened to the reality that in Norway we are sheltered from war and poverty, and don't need to have politics aimed at utility for people; we can live on ideals. Like my parents at the end of the 60s, both rich kids and without knowledge of more evil in the world than theoretical injustice, and my contempt stems from the fact that they never gave me the opportunities they themselves got from their parents. Watch what you say, or they'll call you radical.

I remember my mother complaining that she didn't get as nice a car for her 18th birthday, while I, thanks to a chaotic youth, never got either money or stability to get a driver's license for a car at all. The contrast between mother's complaining about too poor a new car and my own chaotic youth without a license had surely left marks. If I hadn't complicated my life. The questions cut too deep for a simple man.

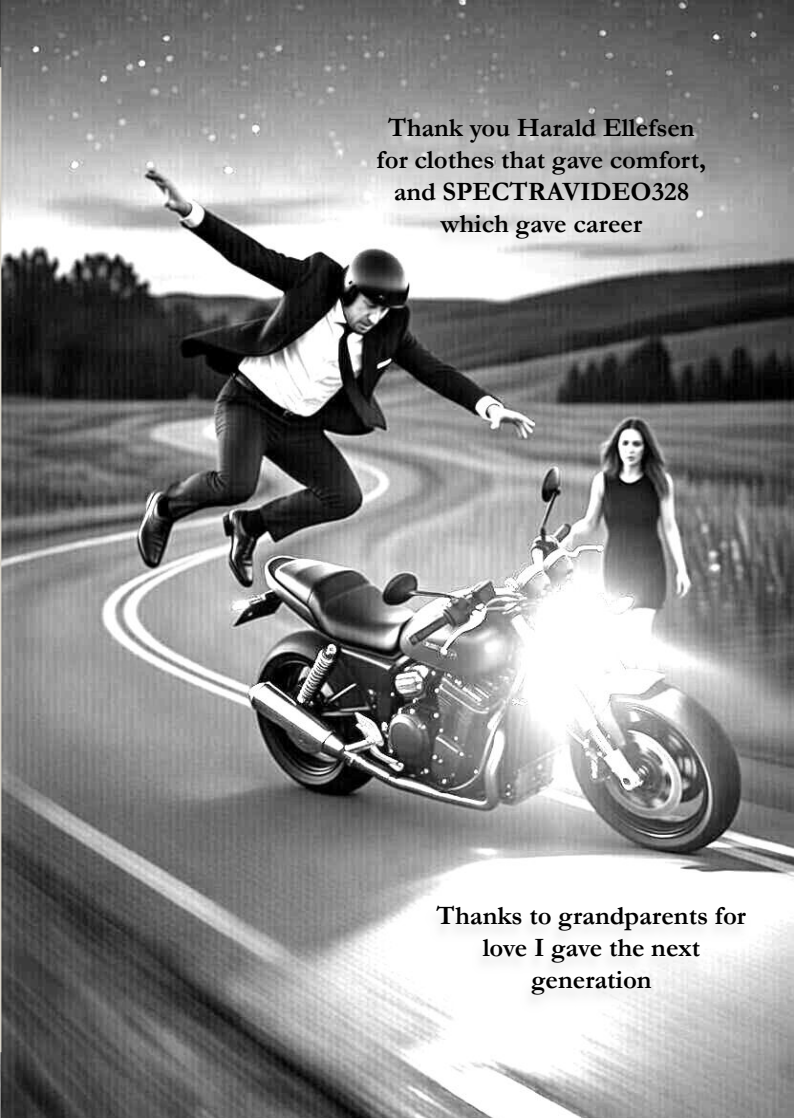
My parents were free 68ers, but for me they became emotionally passive vegetables in their own abundance; it was so chaotic at home during my adolescence that I didn't have a job long enough to pay for such things, and mother's money went to the swimming pool in the garden and father's to a luxury apartment behind the palace and the ocean sailer. Respectable, presentable, a vegetable!

I see the absurdity that my grandparents' money went to my parents' swimming pool and ocean sailer, while my own existence was in constant dissolution, and we lived like poor people in a wealthy family. I know it sounds absurd.

Mother and father wanted children, but did they want to raise them? Maybe I would have been happier if I inherited their Machiavellianism and maybe not. In my youth, I had hope of finding my identity. But please, tell me who I am.

At another table in the student café sits a man in his mid-twenties and clears his throat loudly about once a minute. A cry for help and attention with anxiety culminating in too little natural breath. I think of my own occasionally high shoulders and lack of breath as a child. As an adult, it became a deafening motorcycle tearing through the night. It took a near-fatal accident to remove enough of the attention-seeking need for me to live relatively safely. That's a good thing, even though women and society give advantages to the loud and aggressive; calm and safety can be rewarded with rest. The man clearing his throat for air mirrors my own earlier escape at 200 km/h to drown out my inner anxiety. Before, the machine was the only cry for help, but I am reborn.

The need for attention is gone; I have found calm, natural breath, and a life that is my own. The beauty of one's own calm.


Thank you Harald Ellefsen
for clothes that gave comfort,
and SPECTRAVIDEO328
which gave career
Thanks to grandparents for
love I gave the next
generation